

Section B – Long Form Television Drama

Section B consists of an **in-depth** study requiring learners to explore television as a media form. This section also gives learners the opportunity to draw together elements from their full course of study, including different areas of the media theoretical framework and media contexts.

As an in-depth study, television must be studied in relation to:

- all four areas of the media theoretical framework (including all related theories)
- all relevant contexts.

In this section, learners will be required to complete a comparative study of **two** contemporary long form television dramas:

- **one** of which **must** be from the set US long form television drama list below;

AND

- **one** of which **must** be from the set European (non-English language) long form television drama list below.

Set US Long Form Television Drama List

- *Mr Robot* (Season 1, Episode 1, June 2015) BBFC 15
- *Killing Eve* (Season 1, Episode 1, September 2018) BBFC 15
- *Atypical* (Season 1, Episode 1, August 2017) BBFC 12
- *Stranger Things* (Season 1, Episode 1, July 2016) BBFC 12

Set European (non-English language) Long Form Television Drama List

- *Lupin* (Season 1, Chapter 1, January 2021) BBFC

- *Trapped* (Season 1, Episode 1, December 2015) BBFC 15
- *Deutschland 83* (Season 1, Episode 1, October 2015) BBFC 15.

Centres should choose the most appropriate long form television dramas for their learners.

Each of the set episodes of the television programmes is an example of a contemporary US and European long form television drama.

The European television drama must be viewed in its original language.

*The set episode of *Money Heist* has a BBFC rating of 15, as do all episodes of season one. As some episodes in later seasons have a BBFC rating of 18 the series as whole is rated as 18.

The following indicative list is given as guidance and is not exhaustive.

Learners should use **all** the areas of the media theoretical framework (including theory) in relation to their chosen set television programmes to consider, for example:

- the influence of technological change, including digitally convergent media platforms on the production, marketing, distribution and exhibition of long form television drama in a global context (including the impacts of digital distribution platforms on the contemporary global television industry)
- how audiences consume and interpret long form television dramas in different ways, including a consideration of demographic and technological factors related to consumption
- how media language can be used to subvert or challenge genre conventions and a consideration of other factors such as genre

- the media form specific elements of media language used to create meaning such as camera shots, angles, lighting, settings, locations, costumes, props, makeup, editing and sound
- the values, attitudes and beliefs conveyed by representations and the social and cultural context of these
- how representations may invoke discourse and ideologies and position audiences
- how audiences' response to and interpretations of media representations reflect social and cultural circumstances
- all relevant contexts, for example, a consideration of the economic context behind the large budgets currently given to contemporary US long form television dramas.

Age appropriateness and contextualisation

All of the set television episodes are age appropriate for an A Level programme (BBFC certificated 12 or 15), where it is expected that learners will be aged 15 or over when studying these products. It is the teacher's responsibility to ensure this and to contact OCR should it present any issues.

Assessment of Long Form Television Drama will always focus on the set episodes. However, if centres wish to gain a wider understanding of the chosen set television programme and an understanding of how multiple narrative strands arc and converge across the series, teachers should choose suitable **age appropriate** extracts from other episodes across **season one**. Viewing additional material is optional.

It is the responsibility of the teacher to monitor the content of the selected extracts to ensure that any extracts studied are age appropriate for their learners.

Please be aware when choosing suitable age appropriate extracts that *Money Heist/La Casa de Papel*, Season 1, Episode 1 has a BBFC rating of 15, while the overall TV series has a BBFC rating of 18.